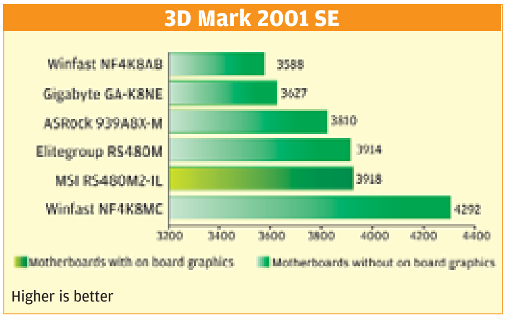


Again, for the ALU/RAM, the 939 socket processors got a bit of an advantage and therefore clocked higher scores. However, this time, the Gigabyte GAK8VM800 board stole MSI RS480M2-IL's shine and beat it quite comfortably, scoring 2839, where the MSI board could manage just 2785, which was the fourth-fastest, and which was superseded by both the TUL motherboards.

The FPU/RAM scores were identical (as they should be) to the ALU/RAM scores, and hence the standings were the same.

Again, in the CPU subsystem benchmarks, those with a 939 processor benefited and clocked fairly higher than their socket 754 counterparts.

The ASRock 939A8x-M and the Elite Group RS480M motherboards, out of the blue, totalled the competition by scoring a massive 11037 and 11024 to comprehensively beat the WinFast NF4K8MC, the third-placed board. The MSI RS470M2-IL did not feature even in the top six, and did rather badly in the CPU subsystem tests.

The ASRock completely dominated these tests and scored the highest in all the tests except CPU Whetstone where it came second with a score of 3794—second only to the Asus K8SMX, which did marginally better and scored 4033.

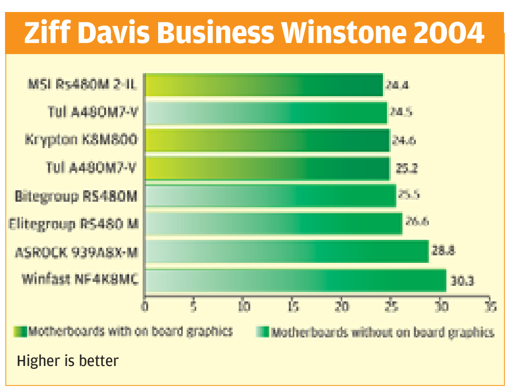
The WinFast NF4K8MC scored 3761 and did not even feature in the top three here.

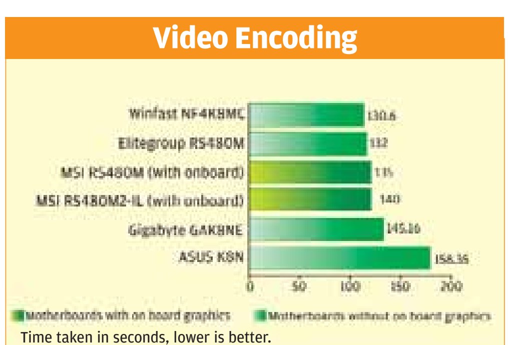
The file system benchmark gives us the data transfer speed from the system to the hard drive and back. The scores were more or less the same throughout this test, except for the MSI RS480M, which scored just 38 on the drive index figure, and the MSIRS480M2-IL, which scored 48. All the others got 51.

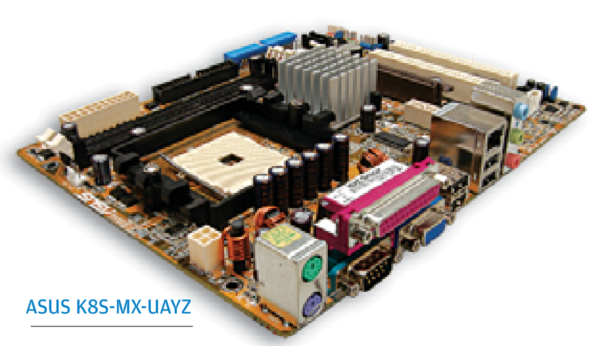
The Krypton M7VIG scored rather poorly here with 25, but that's because it had an IDE drive and did not support SATA. The WinFast NF4K8MC scored the maximum in this test and really started to shine from here on.

Business Winstone is almost an industry standard while trying to measure the performance of a system in everyday office use. Since this is an entry-level motherboard, it won't really be used in gaming, and hence this test is extremely important as it directly targets the segment that these boards will cater to.

The winner here was the WinFast NF4K8MC, which scored an amazing 30.3, a score you would be hard pressed to get out of even higher-end boards. In fact, the top three scores here were quite high, with the ASRock coming in second with 28.8 and the Elite Group RS480M coming in third, scoring 28.3. The MSI RS480M2-IL lost out in a big way, scoring a minuscule 24.4!






ASUS K8S-MX-UAYZ

To get a taste of their real performance, we decided to do a final test and manually clocked the time it took the boards to encode a video file. Encoding a video file is again processor-dependant, and hence the 939-pin boards benefited.

The winner, again, was the WinFast NF4K8MC, which converted the file in just 130 seconds, compared to 132 seconds taken by the Elite Group RS480M. Surprisingly, the MSI RS480M, despite being a 754 processor, clocked 135 seconds. The MSI RS480M2-Il clocked 140, which is poor.

The reason we are emphasising the 10-second difference is because the video file used was a relatively small 100 MB. If ever you try encoding a larger file— say a movie or a home video—it would take significantly longer on the RS480M2-IL than it would on the NF4K8MC.

Needless to say, if you're into any sort of image editing or manipulation, you're better off with the NF4K8MC.

Conclusion

Clearly, the winner here is debatable. Debatable or different, depending on the kind of usage you would put your computer through, and your requirements.

If you would just like to have an entry-level motherboard that gives you everything onboard and don't want to do too many fancy things, the best solution for you would be the MSI RS480M2-IL.

This is a nicely balanced board with all the required features but not necessarily the most advanced features (for example, it has six-channel audio, which is just fine, instead of eight). Hence the MSI-RS480M2-IL gets the *Digit* 'Best